

Graphique Strategies | Part III | Written Proposal

1. Residue

Make the invisible visible / Remove all decoration

Making the Invisible Visible: How much hesitation goes into digital life without a trace?

I keep thinking about the words I type and then delete. Sometimes I change one word; other times I write a whole message and decide not to send it. Those words existed, even if only for a few seconds, but the final text gives no indication that they were ever there. I want to collect these erasures and see whether they reveal anything about how I think, hesitate, or choose how to express myself.

For this project, I would make a code-generated book from one week of my own typing. A local browser extension would record what I delete and how long each fragment existed, keeping everything on my laptop. I would then use JavaScript to turn the logs into an InDesign book that could regenerate with each new collection of text.

The words I keep would sit on paper, with the deleted words printed on vellum over them. Lifting the vellum would separate what I eventually said from the possibilities that came before it. I also want to try removing the surviving text entirely. Following “Remove all decoration,” these pages would contain only what did not make it into the final version, with spacing and typography shaped by the recorded data. I would consider color coding it based off concept and why exactly I deleted it in the first place. This would also be used as a bridge to delve into my interest of data visualization too.

I would first share the book with my class to see how people read these fragments. A deletion might suggest uncertainty, but it could also be a spelling correction or a thought I no longer agree with. Can hesitation become legible through this collection? How much can someone understand from the words I removed, and how much would they have to imagine?

2. The Weight of Waiting

Introduce a new perspective / Create a data visualization

Making the Immaterial Material: Does time have weight?

Five minutes waiting for a train does not always feel like five minutes waiting for a reply. I might barely notice one and spend the other checking my phone repeatedly. I want to explore that difference between the time a clock records and the time I feel passing.

Over two weeks, I would log everyday waits: subway platforms, loading screens, lines, replies, and other moments I usually forget once they end. Alongside the actual duration, I would estimate how long each wait felt and note whether it was frustrating, exciting, uncertain, or easy to sit through. I would also record whether I knew when it would end and whether I had something to occupy myself.

These observations would become a visualization using matter.js, with each wait appearing as an object in a shared space. Longer waits could create larger objects, while waits that felt longer than they were could behave as though they carried more weight. Color could show the feeling attached to a wait, and darkness could indicate how burdensome it was. I would begin with a few variables and test which ones help someone understand the differences.

As more waits enter the space, they would collect, press against one another, or settle. Printed stills would let me compare how this buildup changes over the two weeks.

"Introduce a new perspective" makes me think about giving time qualities we can see and compare. I want someone to look at two equally long waits and understand why one might feel heavier. The project would also let me notice which kinds of waiting take up the most space in my own day.

3. Said Aloud

Take us on a journey / One idea, many forms

Making the Ephemeral Permanent: Does preserving a moment strip away what made it matter?

I want to make a book of everything I say in one day. Speech takes up so much of everyday life, but most of it disappears without becoming something we can return to. I am curious about what I would notice if I could read a day of my own voice, including the repetitions, unfinished thoughts, and ordinary conversations I would otherwise forget. Would the way I sound on paper feel familiar to me?

Moving between five languages is part of this. I want to see when those switches happen and whether they connect to a person, a place, or something I find easier to express in a particular language. Some changes might be deliberate, while others might only become noticeable once I see them on the page.

I would collect recordings of my own speech, with consent wherever recording involves others, and use Whisper to produce an initial transcript. After checking it, especially around language switches, I would use basil.js to generate a printed volume. Each language would have its own color, allowing a reader to follow the shifts through the day. Pauses, repetitions, and unfinished sentences would remain part of the text.

"Take us on a journey" connects to following the day as it unfolds. "One idea, many forms" connects to the different ways the same voice expresses itself.

I imagine sharing the book with multilingual readers and people who code-switch. I want to see whether they recognize something of their own experience, while questioning what the transcript can preserve. The words would remain, but the tone, gestures, and circumstances that gave them meaning might be harder to hold onto.